cynical in its recklessness...The efforts of a century sacrificed and nothing or next to nothing in return.'[33] On 6 February 1908 Curzon even spoke for over an hour in the House of Lords against the convention, attacking it as 'one-sided, unequal and inequitable'.[34] Unfortunately for him, Curzon would have to wait over ten years before he would get the chance to rectify Grey's alleged mistake.

For others in Britain, it was the fact that their government had collaborated with autocratic Russia that proved most odious. As Lord Minto (viceroy of India, 1905–1910), declared: 'we have acted hand in glove with the most abominable autocracy of modern times'.[35] This was also one of those rare moments in politics when both Conservatives and Liberals were drawn together in condemnation of government policy. For, while the former lamented the perceived sacrifice of British rights in Persia, the latter were equally critical of the apparent callous disregard for the interests of Persia itself which the convention entailed. So strong was the reaction against the convention that a 'Grey Must Go' campaign was even conducted in the newspapers Nation and Daily News between 1911 and 1912.[36] In October 1908, a Persia Society was formed by one of the leading scholars of Persia of the time, E.G. Browne, which voiced vehement criticism of the convention.[37] Browne had the particular advantage of possessing a great amount of information on Persia to which the Foreign Office did not have access – the personal contacts of Browne virtually amounted to an independent intelligence service within Persia.[38] Having been a contemporary of Curzon's at Eton, Browne found the ex-viceroy a useful ally in his fight against the 1907 convention. Indeed, as Browne's co-chair of the Persia Society, H.F.B. Lynch, noted in 1911, 'a nod from Curzon will have more effect upon the Government than the frowns of our collective wisdom'.[39] Yet, despite such confidence in Curzon's apparent influence over the government, the convention remained. Soon, the First World War would prove a distraction and the Persia Society's activities would cease. Grey would also manage to hang on to office, always convinced that the 1907 agreement served as a restraining influence on Russian behaviour in Persia.[40] The idea of controlling Russia via treaty would be used by others later when trying to justify the creation of the 1921 trade agreement.